Validation Applicability Mapping Module (VAMM)

Architecture Ecosystem: Structured Reality Standards™
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Governed Space

Validation Applicability Mapping

Canonical Definition

Validation Applicability Mapping Module (VAMM) defines the governance framework for identifying, mapping, bounding, documenting, and maintaining the conditions under which a validation and its resulting determination may legitimately apply.

It establishes the conditions necessary to connect validation to the specific uses, environments, populations, jurisdictions, configurations, operating conditions, time periods, decision contexts, dependency states, and other circumstances for which the validation was designed and performed.

Operational Role

VAMM governs the applicability layer of Validation Purpose & Scope governance.

Its role is to establish **where, when, how, and under which conditions a validation may legitimately apply** before its eventual determination is interpreted or relied upon.

VAMM prevents validation from becoming detached from the conditions under which it was established.

Module Operational Space

VAMM governs:

- validation applicability,
- applicability conditions,
- applicability boundaries,
- intended-use applicability,
- operational applicability,
- environmental applicability,
- population applicability,
- jurisdictional applicability,
- temporal applicability,
- configuration applicability,
- decision-context applicability,
- dependency applicability,
- conditional applicability,
- applicability expansion,
- applicability contraction,
- applicability change,
- and applicability traceability.

Module Function

VAMM applies wherever a validation result may later be used,
transferred, interpreted, referenced, or relied upon.

Its function is to prevent:

- validation performed for one use being automatically applied to another,
- validation established in one environment being generalized to materially different environments,
- validation for one population being extended to unexamined populations,
- validation applying indefinitely despite temporal change,
- validation being transferred between materially different configurations,
- jurisdiction-specific validation being represented as universally applicable,
- dependency changes being ignored,
- and validation determinations being relied upon outside their governed conditions.

Applicability Dimensions

Validation applicability may depend upon multiple dimensions.

Use Applicability

Defines the uses, functions, purposes, or applications for which
validation is intended to support interpretation or reliance.

Operational Applicability

Defines the operating conditions, workflows, deployment modes, and operational circumstances under which validation applies.

Environmental Applicability

Defines the technical, physical, organizational, social, institutional, or other environments covered by validation.

Population Applicability

Defines the users, affected persons, groups, datasets, subjects, customers, operators, or populations for which validation is applicable.

Jurisdictional Applicability

Defines the legal, regulatory, geographic, institutional, or governance jurisdictions within which validation may be applicable.

Temporal Applicability

Defines the period, lifecycle stage, operational window, or time-dependent conditions within which validation remains applicable.

Configuration Applicability

Defines the versions, configurations, deployment arrangements, interfaces, components, or system states to which validation applies.

Decision-Context Applicability

Defines which decisions or decision environments the validation is intended to support.

Dependency Applicability

Defines the external dependencies, services, data sources, infrastructure, relationships, or other conditions whose continued existence or state affects validation applicability.

Applicability Mapping

VAMM converts applicable validation conditions into a structured
Validation Applicability Map.

The map should make it possible to determine:

Validation Determination + Governed Conditions → Legitimate Applicability

The Validation Applicability Map may identify:

- applicable conditions,
- non-applicable conditions,
- conditional applicability,
- known applicability boundaries,
- unresolved applicability areas,
- and conditions capable of terminating or modifying applicability.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Identify Applicability Dimensions

Determine which use, operational, environmental, population, jurisdictional, temporal, configuration, decision, dependency, or other dimensions materially affect validation applicability.

2. Define Applicable Conditions

Establish the conditions under which the validation is intended to apply.

3. Define Non-Applicable Conditions

Identify known conditions under which the validation should not be interpreted as applicable.

4. Establish Conditional Applicability

Where applicability depends upon specific assumptions or continuing conditions, document those conditions explicitly.

5. Preserve Applicability Traceability Maintain:

- applicability dimensions,
- applicable conditions,
- non-applicable conditions,
- conditional applicability,
- assumptions,
- applicability changes,
- relationship to Validation Purpose and Scope,
- timestamps,
- and sufficient traceability throughout the validation lifecycle.

Applicability Is Not Scope

VAMM preserves an important methodological distinction.

Validation Scope determines what validation examines.

Validation Applicability determines where the resulting validation

may legitimately apply.

These may overlap, but they are not identical.

A validation may examine a system under a defined set of conditions while the resulting determination remains applicable only to a subset of operational uses.

Likewise, broad technical examination does not automatically establish broad operational applicability.

Applicability Expansion

A request to apply validation beyond its established applicability does not automatically extend the existing validation.

Expansion may involve:

- new use cases,
- new populations,
- new environments,
- additional jurisdictions,
- different configurations,
- higher-consequence decisions,
- changed dependencies,
- or extended time periods.

Before applicability is expanded, VALIDOS® governance should determine whether the existing scope, depth, criteria, methodology, evidence, and execution sufficiently support the proposed expansion.

Where they do not, additional validation or revalidation may be required.

Applicability Contraction

Applicability may also need to be reduced.

This may occur where:

- new limitations are discovered,
- operating conditions change,
- dependencies deteriorate,
- evidence becomes outdated,
- regulatory conditions change,
- object behavior changes,
- or new validation information reveals that previous applicability was too broad.

VAMM allows validation applicability to contract without requiring the entire Validation Object to be automatically classified as invalid.

Applicability Change Governance

Material changes affecting applicability must remain governable.

A change should trigger reassessment where it may alter whether the existing validation remains suitable for:

- the intended use,
- operational environment,
- relevant population,
- jurisdiction,
- configuration,
- decision context,
- dependency structure,
- or time period.

VAMM therefore creates an important bridge to later **Validation Reliance & Revalidation** governance.

Use Case 1 — AI Model Across Jurisdictions

Scenario

An AI model has been validated for a defined financial-service application within one regulatory environment and is later proposed for deployment in another jurisdiction.

Application

VAMM identifies jurisdiction as a material applicability dimension and determines that the original validation does not automatically establish applicability within the new regulatory environment.

Result

The original validation remains intact while its applicability is correctly bounded until the additional environment is governed.

Use Case 2 — Healthcare AI Across Populations

Scenario

A healthcare AI system is validated using data and operating conditions representing a defined patient population.

The organization later proposes its use for a materially different population.

Application

VAMM identifies population applicability as a governed condition and prevents the existing validation determination from being automatically generalized.

Result

The system may remain validated for the original population while additional validation is considered for the proposed population.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation Applicability Mapping Module establishes the canonical governance framework for determining where, when, how, and under which conditions validation may legitimately apply. By governing use, operational, environmental, population, jurisdictional, temporal, configuration, decision-context, and dependency applicability, VAMM prevents validation determinations from being generalized beyond their governed conditions and creates the applicability map required for trustworthy interpretation, reliance, and future revalidation.

Parent Resources

→ VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer

→ VALIDOS® Architecture Map

→ VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index

Internal Module Flow

→ Previous module: Validation Depth Calibration Module (VDCM)

→ Next module: Validation Limitation Governance Module (VLGM)

Related Documents

→ Validation Purpose & Scope Standard

→ About Validation Purpose & Scope Standard

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Canonical Source

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